LinkedIn Profile Blueprint: Three Model Profiles for Senior PGDM Students

Prepared for the SoIM PGDM batch. Companion to the LinkedIn Profile Audit Report and the Assessment Sheet.

How to use this guide

The audit sheet tells students *what* to check. This guide shows them *what the finished result looks like*. It contains three complete mock profiles, written section by section, in the same order as the Assessment Sheet (A to L):

1. **Ananya Kapoor**: HR specialisation (Talent Acquisition, HR Operations, HR Analytics)
2. **Rohit Menon**: Marketing specialisation (Digital Marketing, Brand Strategy)
3. **Divya Nambiar**: Finance / Business Analytics / Accounting specialisation

All names, companies, numbers and testimonials are **fictional and illustrative**. The experience, structure and level of detail are modelled on the kind of experience our senior students typically have (internships, live projects, college committees, certifications).

Important for students: copy the *structure and thinking*, not the content. Every number on your own profile must be true and traceable to your internship certificate, manager, or project file. If you do not have a number, describe the scale honestly ("a team of 4 recruiters", "weekly report") instead of inventing one.

Five rules that apply to every profile

1. **Every section answers a recruiter's question.** Headline: *what do you do?* About: *why you?* Experience: *what did you actually achieve?* Skills: *can I find you in a search?*
2. **Experience bullets follow Action, Method, Outcome.** Start with a strong verb, say how you did it (tool, method, scale), and end with a result or the size of the work.
3. **Keywords are your search engine.** Recruiters search by role and tool names ("Talent Acquisition", "Power BI", "SEO"). If the word is not on your profile, you are not in the results.
4. **The profile must match the resume.** Same titles, dates and spellings. Recruiters check.
5. **First-person, formal, error-free.** No slang, no emoji clutter, no "hardworking, passionate team player" without proof.

PROFILE 1: HR SPECIALISATION

Mock student: Ananya Kapoor | PGDM (HR & Business Analytics), 2025 to 2027 | Target roles: HR Executive, Talent Acquisition Associate, HR Operations Executive, HR Analyst

A. Photo and Cover Page (15 marks)

Profile photo

- Solo, head-and-shoulders shot; face fills roughly 60% of the frame, eyes at the upper third.
- Dark blazer or smart formal top; plain light-grey or white wall behind; natural window light facing her, not behind her.
- Gentle, genuine smile. No filters, sunglasses, cropped group photo or festival shot.
- Minimum 400 x 400 px, sharp, uploaded in good resolution.

Banner (1584 x 396 px)

- Deep navy background with a subtle teal accent line.
- Text, placed in the centre-right so the profile photo does not cover it: **"People Operations | Talent Acquisition | HR Analytics"** and below it, smaller, **"PGDM (HR) | School of Innovation and Management, Hyderabad"**.
- Maximum two lines of text, large enough to read on a phone. No stock-photo clutter and no personal brand logos.

B. Headline (10 marks)

Weak (default): *Student at SoIM*

Model headline (about 165 characters; the limit is 220):

> PGDM (HR) '27 | Talent Acquisition & HR Operations | Power BI & Excel for HR Analytics | IT Recruitment Intern | Open to HR Roles in Hyderabad

Why it works

- Names the course and graduation year, so recruiters know when she is available.
- Uses searchable keywords: *Talent Acquisition, HR Operations, HR Analytics, Power BI*.
- Shows proof (internship) and intent (open to HR roles, with location).
- No emojis, no slang, no "aspiring" or "seeking opportunities" filler.

C. About / Summary (10 marks)

Model About section (first person, about 230 words):

> I help hiring teams find the right people faster, and I use data to check whether the process is actually working.
>
> I am a second-year PGDM student (HR & Business Analytics) at the School of Innovation and Management, Hyderabad. Over the past year I have worked on both sides of the HR function: recruitment at an IT services company and day-to-day HR operations at a manufacturing firm.
>
> **What I have done** • Sourced and screened candidates for 10+ technology requisitions (Java, Python, AWS, Data Engineering) using Boolean search, Naukri and an ATS. • Coordinated 60+ L1 and L2 interviews and onboarded 12 candidates against client requirements. • Maintained employee records and attendance data for 200+ employees, feeding a monthly HR dashboard. • Built an Excel attrition dashboard that highlights turnover patterns by department and tenure.
>
> **What I bring** Structured follow-up, accurate record-keeping, comfort with HR data (Power BI, advanced Excel) and a habit of closing the loop with candidates and managers.
>
> **What I am looking for** Graduate trainee or executive roles in Talent Acquisition, HR Operations or HR Analytics. I am based in Hyderabad and open to relocation.
>
> If you are hiring, or would like to talk about recruitment and people analytics, please message me or write to ananya.kapoor@email.com.

Why it works: it answers the five audit questions (who, what, for whom, what value, what next), uses evidence instead of adjectives, and ends with a clear call to action. The first three lines are visible before "see more", so the opening line carries the main promise.

D. Experience (10 marks)

Every entry needs: title, company (linked to its LinkedIn page), employment type, location, dates, 3 to 4 bullets and tagged skills.

1. Talent Acquisition Intern | Nexora Technologies (fictional) | Internship | Hyderabad | Mar 2026 to Jun 2026 · 4 mos

- Sourced and screened candidates for 10+ technical requisitions (Java Full Stack, Python, AWS, Data Engineering) using Boolean search and Naukri, building a pipeline of 150+ screened profiles.

- Maintained the recruitment tracker in the ATS; ran bulk resume parsing and duplicate removal so four recruiters worked from one clean database.
- Scheduled and followed up on 60+ L1 and L2 interviews, reaching around 85% candidate attendance through reminder calls.
- Supported onboarding of 12 candidates by coordinating documents and joining dates with the client team.
- *Skills:* Talent Acquisition · Boolean Search · Applicant Tracking Systems · Stakeholder Management

2. HR Operations Intern | Brightline Manufacturing Pvt. Ltd. (fictional) | Internship | Hyderabad | Feb 2026 to Mar 2026 · 2 mos

- Maintained employee master data and daily attendance for 200+ employees, feeding a monthly HR dashboard for the HR Head.
- Coordinated induction for 15 new joiners: document verification, system access and orientation schedule.
- Supported two training sessions by managing nominations, attendance and feedback forms (average rating 4.3 out of 5).
- *Skills:* HR Operations · Onboarding · MS Excel · Employee Records

3. Treasurer, Corporate Connect Council | SoIM | Part-time (campus leadership) | Aug 2025 to Present

- Own the budget and expense records for six council events; reconciled every event against its approved budget.
- Coordinate with 12 student volunteers and the faculty coordinator on sponsorship and vendor payments.

Handling short or unrelated experience (for example a retail internship): keep it if it shows people management or customer handling, but write one or two lines only, or move it to "Volunteer" or the About section. Do not let it push the HR experience down.

Gaps: if there is a gap between degrees or jobs, add a short line ("Completed BBA, then prepared for PGDM admission") rather than leaving it blank.

E. Education (5 marks)

- **School of Innovation and Management (SoIM), G. Narayanamma Institute of Technology & Science** (linked, logo visible) | PGDM, Human Resources & Business Analytics | 2025 to 2027
- *Activities and societies:* Treasurer, Corporate Connect Council; Event Head, Annual Management Fest; Member, HR Club.

- *Description:* Coursework in Talent Management, Compensation and Benefits, Labour Laws, HR Analytics, Organisational Behaviour. Capstone: Team Dynamics using Tuckman's stages.
- **BBA (Retail Operations & Management)** | 2022 to 2025. Add CGPA only if it is strong.

F. Skills (8 marks)

Pin these three on top (they match the target role): Talent Acquisition · Human Resources (HR) · HR Analytics

Add at least 12 more, mixing technical and soft skills:

- *Domain/technical:* Recruitment, Boolean Search, Applicant Tracking Systems (ATS), Onboarding, Employee Engagement, HR Operations, Power BI, Microsoft Excel (advanced), Data Analysis
- *Behavioural/leadership:* Stakeholder Management, Communication, Event Management, Team Leadership, Time Management

Endorsements: ask three classmates and two supervisors to endorse the top three. Endorse theirs first.

G. Certifications, Projects and Additional Sections (6 marks)

Licences and certifications (always issuer, issue date and credential ID or link)

- Human Resource Management | issuing body | month and year
- Foundations of Power BI | issuing body | month and year
- Business Analytics Essentials | issuing body | month and year

Projects

- **Grievance Redressal Framework (HRM project)**: Designed a three-stage grievance process (intake, escalation, resolution) with confidentiality rules and a seven-day closure target. Tools: Word, Excel. *Attach the PDF.*
- **Employee Attrition Dashboard**: Built an Excel dashboard analysing turnover by department and tenure. Identified the highest-risk group and recommended two retention actions. *Attach screenshot.*

Honours and awards: add competition prizes, scholarships, case-competition finals.

Languages: English (Professional working), Hindi (Native or bilingual), Telugu (Native or bilingual).

H. Recommendations (5 marks)

Aim for **two to three** written recommendations. The best mix: one internship supervisor, one faculty member, one peer or committee lead.

Sample from an internship supervisor:

> "Ananya joined our recruitment team as an intern and quickly became dependable. She kept the tracker accurate, followed up with candidates without being reminded and handled interview scheduling for several open requisitions. She would be an asset to any talent acquisition team."

Sample from a faculty member:

> "Ananya consistently brings structured thinking to HR coursework. Her grievance-handling project showed clear process design and an understanding of confidentiality. She also leads by example in college committees."

I. Connections and Network (10 marks)

Target: 500+ connections within 30 days, quality first.

- HR leaders and recruiters in Hyderabad (IT services, manufacturing, BFSI)
- SoIM alumni working in HR and talent teams
- Faculty, guest speakers and corporate connect contacts
- Internship supervisors and colleagues
- Classmates and juniors

Follow: companies she wants to work for, HR communities and publications, five to ten HR thought leaders, and hashtags such as #TalentAcquisition #HRAnalytics #Recruitment #PeopleOperations.

Connection note (under 300 characters):

> Hello Mr./Ms. [Name], I am a PGDM (HR) student at SoIM, Hyderabad, with recent experience in IT recruitment. I follow your work on [topic] and would value connecting. Thank you.

J. Profile Setup and Visibility (7 marks)

- **Custom URL:** linkedin.com/in/ananya-kapoor-hr

- **Location:** Hyderabad, Telangana, India. **Industry:** Human Resources Services (or Staffing and Recruiting).
- **Contact info:** professional email (name only, no nicknames), phone optional, LinkedIn URL.
- **Open to Work:** set job titles (HR Executive, Talent Acquisition Associate, HR Operations Executive), location, and visibility to **recruiters only** unless she wants the public green frame.
- **Featured section:** resume PDF, attrition dashboard screenshot, best post.
- **Profile strength target:** All-Star.

K. Activity and Engagement (6 marks)

Cadence: two posts per month plus three thoughtful comments per week.

Model post (about 120 words):

> What I learned from screening 400+ resumes in four months:
>
> 1. Candidates who customise their headline and summary get shortlisted faster than those who send a generic profile.
> 2. A clean tracker saves more time than any tool.
> 3. A quick "Is this still a good time to talk?" message raises interview attendance.
> 4. Metrics matter. Even a simple Excel dashboard shows where candidates drop off.
>
> I am now building these learnings into my PGDM HR project. If you work in talent acquisition, I would love to hear what you wish students knew before applying.
>
> #TalentAcquisition #HRAnalytics #Recruitment #PGDM

Other post ideas: a certification you earned, your project dashboard, a takeaway from a guest lecture, an event you organised.

L. Format, Language and Professionalism (8 marks)

- One spelling convention throughout (Indian or British English).
- Same date format everywhere ("Mar 2026 to Jun 2026").
- Same bullet style; sentences end with full stops or none, but consistently.
- Capitalise job titles and tool names correctly (Power BI, not power bi).
- Read the profile once on a phone. If it is hard to scan, shorten it.

PROFILE 2: MARKETING SPECIALISATION

Mock student: Rohit Menon | PGDM (Marketing), 2025 to 2027 | Target roles: Digital Marketing Executive, Brand Executive, Marketing Analyst, Management Trainee (Marketing)

A. Photo and Cover Page (15 marks)

Profile photo

- Solo, head-and-shoulders; light-coloured formal shirt or a plain blazer; clean neutral background (a wall or softly blurred office, not a street or a mirror selfie).
- Looking at the camera, confident and approachable. A marketing profile can be slightly warmer and more colourful than a finance one, but it must still be professional.
- Sharp, even lighting, minimum 400 x 400 px.

Banner (1584 x 396 px)

- Clean design with one brand colour (for example deep orange on charcoal), made in Canva. Marketing students are judged on visual taste, so the banner itself is a mini portfolio piece.
- Text: **"Brand Strategy | Digital Marketing | Consumer Insights"**, with a small line: **"PGDM Marketing | SoIM, Hyderabad"**. Keep text away from the bottom-left where the photo sits.

B. Headline (10 marks)

Weak (default): *PGDM Student | Marketing*

Model headline (about 170 characters):

> PGDM Marketing '27 | Digital Marketing & Brand Strategy | SEO, Google Analytics 4 & Meta Ads | Doubled D2C Instagram Engagement | Seeking Brand / Digital Marketing Roles

Why it works: a recruiter searching "digital marketing", "SEO" or "Google Analytics" can find him. The result ("doubled engagement") is a hook that makes people open the profile.

C. About / Summary (10 marks)

Model About section (about 240 words):

> I turn consumer insight into campaigns that people notice and brands can measure.
>
> I am a PGDM Marketing student at the School of Innovation and Management, Hyderabad. Before my PGDM I completed a BBA and spent a year managing campus brand activations. Over the last six months I have worked on digital marketing for a D2C personal-care brand and on a field research project for an FMCG distributor.
>
> **Highlights** • Planned and executed a 10-week Instagram and email content calendar that lifted engagement rate from 2.1% to 4.3%. • Ran three paid Meta campaigns with a combined ₹25,000 budget and reduced cost per lead by 22% through audience and creative testing. • Surveyed 180 consumers across 6 retail clusters and presented a pricing and pack-size recommendation to the regional sales head. • Built a Google Analytics 4 dashboard that tracked traffic, source and conversion for the brand website.
>
> **Strengths** Consumer research, content planning, campaign analytics, and storytelling with data. I enjoy the space where creativity meets numbers.
>
> **Looking for** Digital marketing, brand management or marketing analytics roles with consumer brands, agencies or tech companies.
>
> Let's connect. You can reach me at rohit.menon@email.com or message me here.

Why it works: it opens with a promise, uses numbers wherever the truth allows, and shows both creative and analytical sides. A marketing About should itself read like good copy: short lines, no jargon pile-up.

D. Experience (10 marks)

1. Digital Marketing Intern | Veda Naturals (fictional D2C brand) | Internship | Hyderabad (Hybrid) | Jun 2026 to Aug 2026 · 3 mos

- Planned and published a 10-week content calendar (reels, carousels, email) for Instagram and the newsletter, lifting engagement rate from 2.1% to 4.3%.
- Set up and ran three Meta Ads campaigns on a ₹25,000 budget; tested four audiences and two creatives, cutting cost per lead by 22%.
- Wrote and A/B tested subject lines for three email campaigns, reaching a 28% average open rate against a 19% baseline.
- Built a weekly performance report in Google Analytics 4 and Excel, which the founder used to decide next-month spend.
- *Skills:* Digital Marketing · Meta Ads Manager · Google Analytics 4 · Content Strategy · Email Marketing

2. Marketing Research Intern | Sunrise FMCG Distributors (fictional) | Internship | Hyderabad | Dec 2025 to Jan 2026 · 2 mos

- Designed a 12-question consumer survey and collected 180 responses across six retail clusters.
- Analysed results in Excel (pivot tables, cross-tabs) to compare price sensitivity by pack size.
- Presented a two-slide recommendation on pack-size and pricing to the regional sales head; two of the three suggestions were taken into the next-quarter plan.
- *Skills:* Market Research · Consumer Behaviour · Data Analysis · Presentation Skills

3. Marketing Head, Annual Management Fest | SoIM | Volunteer (campus leadership) | Aug 2025 to Feb 2026

- Led a 15-member team that promoted the fest through Instagram, WhatsApp communities and college outreach, bringing in 600+ registrations.
- Negotiated sponsorship with 5 local businesses worth ₹1.2 lakh in cash and kind.

E. Education (5 marks)

- **SoIM, GNITS** (linked) | PGDM, Marketing | 2025 to 2027
- *Activities:* Marketing Head, Management Fest; Member, Marketing Club; Participant, Inter-B-School Marketing Case Competition.
- *Coursework:* Consumer Behaviour, Brand Management, Digital Marketing, Marketing Analytics, Sales and Distribution, Services Marketing.
- **BBA** | 2022 to 2025.

F. Skills (8 marks)

Pin: Digital Marketing · Brand Management · Marketing Strategy

Add at least 12 more:

- *Domain/technical:* Search Engine Optimization (SEO), Google Analytics, Meta Ads Manager, Social Media Marketing, Content Marketing, Email Marketing, Market Research, Consumer Behaviour, Canva, Microsoft Excel, Marketing Analytics
- *Behavioural/leadership:* Storytelling, Presentation Skills, Team Leadership, Negotiation, Creativity

Order matters: keep the skills recruiters search for most (SEO, Google Analytics, Social Media Marketing) in the top ten.

G. Certifications, Projects and Additional Sections (6 marks)

Licences and certifications (issuer, date, credential link)

- Google Analytics Certification | Google | month and year
- Fundamentals of Digital Marketing | Google Digital Garage | month and year
- Meta Certified Digital Marketing Associate (if taken) | Meta | month and year
- HubSpot Content Marketing | HubSpot Academy | month and year

Projects

- **Brand Revival Plan: Regional Snack Brand**: Created a repositioning strategy covering STP, a 4P mix and a 90-day social campaign for a fictional legacy brand. Presented to a three-member faculty panel. *Attach the deck.*
- **Competitor Content Audit**: Benchmarked 6 competitors on posting frequency, formats and engagement, and recommended three content gaps. *Attach the one-page summary.*

Honours and awards: Runner-up, Inter-B-School Marketing Case Competition; Best Event Team, Management Fest.

Languages: English (Professional working), Hindi, Telugu, Malayalam.

H. Recommendations (5 marks)

Sample from the internship founder/supervisor:

> "Rohit took ownership of our Instagram and email channels from week one. He proposed a content calendar, tested what worked and reported results every Friday. His campaign data helped us shift budget to the best-performing audience. I would happily work with him again."

Sample from a faculty member:

> "Rohit combines creative thinking with discipline. His brand revival project was well researched and presented with confidence, and he led the fest's marketing team with maturity."

I. Connections and Network (10 marks)

- Brand managers, marketing heads and recruiters at FMCG, D2C, e-commerce, agencies and tech companies in Hyderabad and Bengaluru

- SoIM marketing alumni; guest speakers; faculty
- Founders and marketing leads of start-ups (excellent for internships)
- Agency professionals (digital, creative, media planning)

Follow: target brands, marketing publications and communities, five to ten marketing leaders, and hashtags such as #DigitalMarketing #BrandStrategy #MarketingAnalytics #D2C #SEO.

J. Profile Setup and Visibility (7 marks)

- **Custom URL:** linkedin.com/in/rohit-menon-marketing
- **Location:** Hyderabad, Telangana, India. **Industry:** Marketing Services.
- **Website/portfolio link:** a one-page Notion or Canva portfolio with campaign screenshots and the brand revival deck. Add it to Contact info.
- **Open to Work:** Digital Marketing Executive, Brand Executive, Marketing Analyst; recruiters only.
- **Featured:** campaign report (PDF), banner design, best post, portfolio link.

K. Activity and Engagement (6 marks)

Cadence: two posts per month, with a visual (carousel, screenshot or short video).

Model post:

> We doubled engagement on a D2C brand's Instagram in 10 weeks. No viral trick, just three habits:
>
> 1. We posted fewer formats but tested them every week.
> 2. We reused the best comments and questions from followers as content ideas.
> 3. We reviewed analytics every Friday and killed whatever did not work.
>
> The biggest lesson: marketing is a loop of idea, test and learn. Which habit has worked best for your brand? I would love to learn from you.
>
> #DigitalMarketing #SocialMedia #D2C #MarketingAnalytics

Other post ideas: a teardown of a recent ad campaign, a carousel on pricing psychology, a summary of your case competition, a before-and-after of a design you improved.

L. Format, Language and Professionalism (8 marks)

- Brand names spelled correctly (Instagram, Google Analytics 4, Meta Ads Manager).

- Use "%" and "₹" consistently (₹25,000, not Rs 25k in one place and 25000 in another).
- Keep emojis to none or one tasteful use in the About; never in the headline.
- Check that every link (portfolio, decks, certificates) opens.

PROFILE 3: FINANCE / BUSINESS ANALYTICS / ACCOUNTING

Mock student: Divya Nambiar | PGDM (Finance & Business Analytics), 2025 to 2027 | Target roles: Financial Analyst, FP&A Analyst, Credit/Risk Analyst, Business Analyst, Audit and Assurance Associate

This profile is written for Finance with Analytics. At the end of the profile there is a short table showing how to adjust it for a pure Accounting or pure Business Analytics student.

A. Photo and Cover Page (15 marks)

Profile photo

- Solo, head-and-shoulders; formal attire (blazer or formal shirt); plain neutral background. Finance and banking recruiters tend to be the most conservative, so keep it classic.
- Calm, confident expression; sharp, well-lit, minimum 400 x 400 px.

Banner (1584 x 396 px)

- Navy and silver, minimal design, optionally with a subtle chart line or grid in the background.
- Text: **"Financial Analysis | Financial Modelling | Data-Driven Decisions"** and **"PGDM Finance & Business Analytics | SoIM, Hyderabad"**.

B. Headline (10 marks)

Weak (default): *PGDM Finance student*

Model headline (about 160 characters):

> PGDM Finance & Business Analytics '27 | Financial Analysis & Modelling | Excel, Power BI, SQL | Ex-Banking Operations | Seeking Financial Analyst / FP&A Roles

Why it works: it says her domain, the tools recruiters filter by (Excel, Power BI, SQL), her prior work experience, and the exact roles she wants.

C. About / Summary (10 marks)

Model About section (about 250 words):

> I make financial data easier to understand and easier to act on.
>
> I am a PGDM Finance & Business Analytics student at the School of Innovation and Management, Hyderabad, with a background that combines banking operations, audit exposure and financial analysis. Before my PGDM I worked for 11 months as an Assistant Manager in a bank's corporate securities operations team, where accuracy and compliance were part of every day.
>
> **Highlights** • Reconciled 300+ corporate account transactions a month and cut open discrepancies by 40% by flagging recurring documentation errors to the client onboarding team. • Built a feasibility and project-economics model for a manufacturing plant during a two-month internship at a CA advisory firm, including cost estimation, a five-year projection and a break-even analysis. • Analysed a listed consumer company's financial statements using ratio and trend analysis and presented profitability, liquidity and efficiency insights. • Built an Excel and Power BI dashboard tracking revenue, cost and variance against budget.
>
> **Strengths** Financial statement analysis, modelling, reconciliation, regulatory compliance (NSDL/CDSL), advanced Excel, Power BI, basic SQL and Python.
>
> **Looking for** Financial Analyst, FP&A, Credit Analyst or Business Analyst roles where careful analysis supports business decisions.
>
> I would be glad to connect. You can write to me at divya.nambiar@email.com.

Why it works: it uses her earlier work experience as a strength rather than hiding it, shows the *scale* of the work (300+ transactions a month), and ties tools (Excel, Power BI, SQL) to results.

D. Experience (10 marks)

1. Financial Analyst Intern | Kestrel & Associates LLP (fictional CA advisory firm) | Internship | Hyderabad | Jul 2026 to Sep 2026 · 3 mos

- Prepared feasibility and project-economics models for two manufacturing projects, covering cost estimation, a five-year projection and break-even analysis.
- Researched industry benchmarks and market size to support revenue assumptions in client feasibility reports.
- Built structured Excel schedules (capex, working capital, loan repayment) used in the client's project report.

- Checked the model for formula errors with a peer-review checklist, which reduced review comments from the partner by about half over the internship.
- *Skills:* Financial Modelling · Feasibility Analysis · Advanced Excel · Industry Research · Budgeting

2. Project Intern, ESG Data and Intelligence | GreenLedger Analytics (fictional) | Internship | Remote | May 2026 to Jun 2026 · 2 mos

- Collected and classified ESG disclosures for 40 listed companies into a structured database using a defined scoring framework.
- Organised the data into summary tables that supported the team's quarterly sector report.
- *Skills:* ESG · Data Collection · Data Classification · Research

3. Assistant Manager, Corporate Securities Operations | Meridian Bank Ltd. (fictional) | Full-time | Hyderabad | Jan 2024 to Nov 2024 · 11 mos

- Processed and reconciled 300+ corporate account transactions monthly, achieving 99%+ accuracy and cutting open discrepancies by 40%.
- Verified KYC documents for new corporate accounts, ensuring compliance with depository regulations and internal controls.
- Analysed transaction data to prepare weekly exception reports for the operations head.
- *Skills:* Reconciliation · KYC · Regulatory Compliance · Internal Controls · Data Analysis

4. Audit Intern | Gulf Regional Bank (fictional) | Internship | Aug 2023 to Sep 2023 · 2 mos

- Assisted in internal control testing and documented audit observations using the COSO framework.
- Mapped three financial workflows and flagged control gaps for senior review.

Order: most recent first. **Gap between Nov 2024 and Jul 2025:** add a one-line note under the Meridian role or in the About section, for example: "Left to prepare for and join PGDM (2025)." An explained gap is not a problem; an unexplained gap is.

E. Education (5 marks)

- **SoIM, GNITS** (linked) | PGDM, Finance & Business Analytics | 2025 to 2027
- *Activities:* Finance Club; Student Mentor; participant in the equity research competition.
- *Coursework:* Corporate Finance, Financial Statement Analysis, Investment Analysis, Financial Modelling, Business Analytics, Risk Management.
- **Executive Certificate, General Management** (add institute and year if completed)

- **B.Com (Honours)** | 2019 to 2022. Add percentage/CGPA only when it is strong, and use the same format on the resume.

F. Skills (8 marks)

Pin: Financial Analysis · Financial Modelling · Microsoft Excel

Add at least 12 more:

- *Domain/technical:* Financial Statement Analysis, Budgeting and Forecasting, Variance Analysis, Valuation, Power BI, SQL, Python (basic), Reconciliation, KYC, Audit Support, Internal Controls, Data Visualization
- *Behavioural/leadership:* Analytical Thinking, Attention to Detail, Stakeholder Management, Problem Solving, Presentation Skills

G. Certifications, Projects and Additional Sections (6 marks)

Licences and certifications

- NISM Series V-A: Mutual Fund Distributors | NISM | month and year
- Financial Markets | Yale University (Coursera) | month and year
- Excel Skills for Business: Advanced | Macquarie University (Coursera) | month and year
- Credit Risk Management | issuing body | month and year
- ACCA: papers cleared (list on profile only if actually passed; mention number cleared in the About or in Education)

Projects

- **Financial Statement Analysis: Listed Consumer Company**: Used five years of data, ratio analysis (profitability, liquidity, efficiency, leverage) and a DuPont breakdown to explain changes in return on equity; concluded with investment-oriented observations. *Attach the PDF.*
- **Budget vs Actual Variance Model (Excel)**: Built a model comparing planned and actual cost and revenue, with a variance flag and a summary chart for management.
- **Revenue and Cost Dashboard (Excel + Power BI)**: Designed an interactive dashboard with pivot tables and KPIs; monthly trend and region filters. *Attach screenshot.*

Honours and awards: equity research competition finalist, academic scholarship, if applicable.

Languages: English (Professional working), Hindi, Telugu.

H. Recommendations (5 marks)

Sample from the internship partner:

> "Divya joined our advisory team as an intern and took on feasibility models that normally require more experience. Her Excel work was clean, well documented and accurate. She asked the right questions and met every deadline. I recommend her for any analyst role."

Sample from a faculty member:

> "Divya brings real work experience to the classroom. Her financial statement analysis was thorough and her dashboards explained complex numbers clearly. She is reliable, analytical and a strong team contributor."

I. Connections and Network (10 marks)

- Finance managers, FP&A leaders, credit and risk professionals, bank and NBFC recruiters
- Chartered accountants, CFA/FRM/ACCA professionals, audit and consulting firm contacts
- SoIM finance alumni; guest lecturers and industry mentors
- Analytics professionals (for the business analytics side of the profile)

Follow: target banks, NBFCs, consulting and Big Four firms, finance and analytics communities, and hashtags such as #FinancialAnalysis #FPandA #FinancialModelling #PowerBI #CorporateFinance.

J. Profile Setup and Visibility (7 marks)

- **Custom URL:** linkedin.com/in/divya-nambiar-finance
- **Location:** Hyderabad, Telangana, India. **Industry:** Financial Services (or Banking).
- **Contact info:** professional email; portfolio link to a folder or page with sample models (remove any confidential client data first).
- **Open to Work:** Financial Analyst, FP&A Analyst, Business Analyst, Credit Analyst; recruiters only.
- **Featured:** financial statement analysis PDF, dashboard screenshot, best post.

K. Activity and Engagement (6 marks)

Cadence: one or two posts per month plus regular, thoughtful comments on finance and analytics content.

Model post:

> Three questions I now ask before building any financial model:
>
> 1. What decision will this model support?
> 2. Which three assumptions drive 80% of the result?
> 3. What happens to the answer if those assumptions are 20% worse?
>
> I learned this while building a feasibility model during my internship. A clean spreadsheet is not the goal; a decision someone can trust is. What do you ask before you build?
>
> #FinancialModelling #FPandA #Excel #Finance

Other post ideas: a ratio analysis of a company you studied, a summary of a quarterly result, a Power BI visual with a one-line insight, a certification you completed.

L. Format, Language and Professionalism (8 marks)

- Use the full forms on first use (Financial Planning and Analysis, then FP&A).
- Keep company names and designations identical to the resume and offer letters.
- Do **not** upload client names, confidential figures or internal files. Anonymise everything.
- Double-check every number; a finance profile with a calculation error loses credibility.

How to adjust this profile for other specialisations

Student's focus	Headline emphasis	Pin these skills	Featured section
Accounting / Audit	Audit & Assurance	Auditing, Financial Reporting, Internal Controls	Audit-style workflow documentation (anonymised)
Business Analytics	Data Analytics	SQL, Power BI, Python	Dashboard, GitHub or Kaggle link

Student's focus	Headline emphasis	Pin these skills	Featured section
Banking and Credit	Credit & Risk Analysis	Credit Analysis, Financial Statement Analysis, Risk Management	Credit appraisal case study
Investments	Equity Research	Valuation, Financial Modelling, Equity Research	Equity research note or valuation model

Common Before and After Fixes (All Specialisations)

Section	Before (typical student)	After (model)
Headline	Student at SoIM	PGDM Marketing '27 | Digital Marketing & Brand Strategy | SEO, Google Analytics 4 | Seeking Brand Roles
About	I am a hardworking and passionate student looking for opportunities.	I help hiring teams find the right people faster, and I use data to check whether it is working. (then proof, then a call to action)
Experience	Responsible for recruitment and screening.	Screened 150+ profiles for 10+ technical requisitions using Boolean search and an ATS, building the shortlist for four recruiters.
Skills	Ms office, communication, team work	Pinned: Talent Acquisition, HR Analytics, Power BI, plus 12 role-relevant skills
Projects	Did a project on attrition.	Built an Excel attrition dashboard by department and tenure; recommended two retention actions.
Photo	Group photo, selfie or logo	Solo head-and-shoulders, formal, plain background

Template: How to ask for a recommendation

> Hello Sir/Madam, I hope you are well. I am updating my LinkedIn profile as I prepare for placements. Having worked with you on [project/internship/course], I would be grateful if you could write a short recommendation about [specific strength or work]. I am happy to share a few points to make it easier. Thank you for your time. Regards, [Name]

Tip: send a draft of three bullet points; recommenders who are busy will thank you for it, and the recommendation will be more specific.

30-Day Action Plan (aligned with the audit roadmap)

- **Week 1:** Photo and banner; custom URL; headline; About section.
- **Week 2:** Rewrite each experience entry (Action, Method, Outcome); add 15+ skills; add certifications and projects with links.
- **Week 3:** Request 2 to 3 recommendations; send 25 targeted connection requests; follow target companies; publish the first post; comment three times a week.
- **Week 4:** Add the Featured section; configure Open to Work; align the resume with the profile; self-score using the Assessment Sheet and fix the lowest-scoring section first.

Target score: 75+ out of 100 ("Strong") before placement season; 90+ is "Excellent" and recruiter-ready.